



Gavin Newsom, Governor
State of California
Health and Human Services Agency
DEPARTMENT OF MANAGED HEALTH CARE
980 9th Street, Suite 500
Sacramento, CA 95814
Phone: 916-324-8176 | Fax: 916-255-5241
www.DMHC.ca.gov

February 23, 2026

VIA ELECTRONIC MAIL

Samantha Uiagalelei
UHC of California
5701 Katella Avenue
Cypress, CA 90630

Re: Proposed Contract Termination with Temecula Valley Hospital
Block Transfer Filing No. 2026-HOSP-237
Filed on February 18, 2026

Dear Ms. Samantha Uiagalelei:

The Department of Managed Health Care (Department) is reviewing the information in the above-referenced Block Transfer Filing (Filing) submitted by **UHC of California** (Plan) for compliance with the requirements of the Knox-Keene Health Care Service Plan Act of 1975, as amended (Cal. Health & Safety Code § 1340 *et seq.*) and the regulations promulgated thereunder (Cal. Code Regs., Tit. 28, § 1000 *et seq.*).

In the event of contract termination, the Filing proposes to remove **Temecula Valley Hospital** (Terminating Hospital) from the Plan's hospital network. The effective date of contract termination between the Terminating Hospital and the Plan (Termination Date) is currently **April 30, 2026**.

Please review the following comments and feel free to contact me if you would like to discuss any of the issues before filing the Plan's response.

1. On the Block Transfer Filing Form, the Plan reports zero bed days and zero admits for HMO and PPO enrollees. Please confirm there were zero HMO bed days utilized, zero HMO admits, zero PPO bed days utilized, and zero PPO admits.
2. Please confirm whether the contract termination between the Plan and Temecula Valley Hospital impacts Point of Service (POS) enrollees.
3. The Plan's PPO line of business is licensed by the Department. Please confirm the following:

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- a. The number of PPO members who reside within a 15 mile radius of the Terminating Hospital,
 - b. Whether all of the Alternate Hospitals are in-network facilities for PPO members,
 - c. Whether the Plan's PPO providers can admit for and provide all medically necessary services at the Alternate Hospitals,
 - d. The Plan will send an Enrollee Transfer Notice approved by the Department to all PPO enrollees with a 15 mile radius of the Terminating Hospital.
4. For each affected provider group that primarily utilizes the Terminating Hospital, please summarize or confirm the following:
 - a. The ability of the provider group to redirect enrollees to the Alternate Hospitals:
 - i. Whether there is any specialty for which all of the associated specialists have admitting privileges **only** at the Terminating Hospital and not at any of the Alternate Hospitals,
 1. If yes, please identify the specialty and explain how Plan enrollees assigned to the provider group will receive care and services for that specialty following contract termination.
 - ii. If the provider group does not have any primary care physicians or specialists with admitting privileges to one or more Alternate Hospitals, please explain how its assigned enrollees will be admitted to the Alternate Hospital(s) (e.g. via hospitalists, Plan admission process, etc.).
 1. If hospitalists are utilized, please indicate:
 - a. The name of the group,
 - b. The number of associated hospitalists, and
 - c. If the hospitalists can admit enrollees for any medically necessary services.
5. For each Alternate Hospital, please summarize or confirm the following:
 - a. Whether the Plan has sent or received a notice of contract termination from the Alternate Hospital, and if so, whether that contract is set to terminate within the next six months.
6. Please confirm whether the HMO providers that routinely utilize the Terminating Hospital have adequate admitting privileges for PCPs and specialists to at least one of the identified Alternate Hospitals containing all services that will be lost should the contract ultimately terminate.
7. In addition to the in-patient services comparison on the Block Transfer portal, please indicate any of the following services that are available at the Terminating Hospital, but not available at the Alternate Hospitals:

- a. Any tertiary care, quaternary care, cancer, or other high-level specialty services.

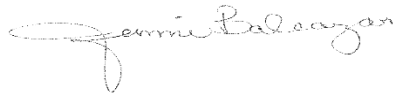
If any services are not available at the Alternate Hospitals, please explain where affected enrollees will receive these services following contract termination.

8. Please identify the number of enrollees who have a procedure scheduled and authorized by the Plan at the Terminating Hospital post-termination.

Please submit the Plan's response by **March 2, 2026**, via the Block Transfer portal as a "Response to Comment Letter."

Please contact me if there are any questions regarding the above.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Jennie Balcazar".

Jennie Balcazar
Analyst I
Office of Plan Monitoring